

Building a Private Chatbot with Generative AI

1. Introduction

This document explains the architecture and workflow of a private chatbot built using **OpenAI's Generative AI models**. The chatbot leverages embeddings and a vector database to provide context-aware responses to user queries.

2. System Flow Overview

The chatbot follows a **retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)** pipeline:

1. Source Data Ingestion

- Raw documents or text sources are provided.
- Examples: PDFs, knowledge base articles, FAQs.

2. Chunking

- Large documents are split into smaller, manageable text chunks.
- This ensures embeddings capture fine-grained meaning.

3. Embedding Generation

- Each chunk is converted into a numerical vector (embedding) using **OpenAI's embedding model**.
- Embeddings represent semantic meaning.

4. Vector Database Storage

- Embeddings are stored in a **vector database** (e.g., Pinecone, Weaviate, FAISS).
- Enables efficient similarity search.

5. User Query Processing

- User submits a query.
- Query is also converted into an embedding.

6. Similarity Search

- The vector database performs a similarity search between the query embedding and stored embeddings.

- Top-ranked results are retrieved.

7. Response Generation

- Retrieved context is passed to the **OpenAI LLM**.
- The LLM generates a coherent, context-aware response.

3. Flowchart Diagram

Code

User Query

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Convert Query → Embedding

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Similarity Search in Vector DB

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Retrieve Ranked Results

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Pass Context → OpenAI LLM

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Generate Final Response

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Return Answer to User

4. Example Workflow

- **Step 1:** Upload company FAQs as source documents.
- **Step 2:** System chunks FAQs into smaller sections.
- **Step 3:** Each section is embedded and stored in Pinecone.
- **Step 4:** User asks: *“How do I reset my password?”*
- **Step 5:** Query embedding is generated.

- **Step 6:** Vector DB retrieves the most relevant FAQ chunk.
- **Step 7:** OpenAI LLM uses retrieved context to generate: *“To reset your password, go to the login page, click ‘Forgot Password,’ and follow the instructions sent to your email.”*

5. Key Components

- **OpenAI Embeddings API** – Converts text into semantic vectors.
- **Vector Database (e.g., Pinecone)** – Stores and retrieves embeddings efficiently.
- **OpenAI LLM (e.g., GPT-4)** – Generates natural language responses using retrieved context.

6. Benefits

- **Contextual Accuracy** – Responses are grounded in stored knowledge.
- **Scalability** – Handles large document sets with efficient search.
- **Privacy** – Works with private datasets, ensuring secure knowledge retrieval.